THE HINDU

Today's Paper » NATIONAL » ANDHRA PRADESH

Published: February 11, 2014 00:00 IST | Updated: February 11, 2014 05:50 IST

Young motorists told not to risk their lives

Special Correspondent

An accident had claimed the lives of four youths going on motorcycles on Bhogi Day this year. The festive spirit turned into gloom at the homes of the victims and the void created in the lives of the near and dear ones would continue to haunt them for the rest of their lives, said Assistant Commissioner of Police (Traffic) L. Arjun. As many as 60 minor drivers and their parents were counselled at a programme organised by the City Police at the Police Kalyana Mandapam here on Monday.

The young boys and girls, who were caught driving two-wheelers, seemed to have understood the gravity of the situation.

The accident had occurred in the early hours on that day and there was hardly any traffic. The victims had their earphones on, had no helmets and were over speeding. No heavy vehicle was involved but the impact of the collision of the motorcycles could be understood by the fact that they died on the spot. Had they worn helmet their lives could have been saved. Nobody came even to touch them and the police got them shifted to the hospital, the ACP said.

“I lay on the road for four hours after being hit by a two-wheeler but no one came to help me,” recalled Dilip Patro, a former software engineer with Tata Elxi, who was hit by a two-wheeler near Mumbai Airport 17 years ago. The accident has confined him to a wheelchair all these years as he suffered a spinal-cord injury. It is a different matter that he set up The Ability People (TAP) to guide persons with spinal-cord injuries, support rehabilitation efforts and to create awareness among road users. Mr. Dilip expressed the view that ‘carelessness’ on the part of motorists was a major cause of accidents and cautioned the young motorists not to endanger the lives of other road users as also their own lives by violating traffic rules. He told them that the TAP was organising counselling programmes on road safety on the Beach Road every day and appealed to them to do their bit in spreading the message. He underlined the importance of shifting a victim to a hospital in the first one hour after an accident. The ‘golden hour’ was crucial for saving the victim. There was no need to worry that they would be unnecessarily harassed by the police.

In case of spinal cord injury, TAP can be contacted on the toll free helpline 1800 425 8911 (Andhra Pradesh).

As many as 60 minor drivers and their parents were counselled by

City Police

Printable version | Feb 11, 2014 6:05:28 PM | http://www.thehindu.com/todays-paper/tp-national/tp-andhrapradesh/young-motorists-told-not-to-risk-their-lives/article5675985.ece

© The Hindu